



Data Protection Education
Unit 1, Saltmore Farm
Hinxworth
Hertfordshire
SG7 5EZ

23rd March 2021

Dear Mr Dring,

We write to you further to your email of the 19th March 2021.

We understand that you are concerned about the use of your data during the complaints process. Following your original letter of complaint the school has investigated and examined the processes used to process data in order to comply and progress complaints procedure and we are satisfied that they have responded appropriately to your concerns.

As we explained in our letter of the 17th March 2021 following your complaint to the ESFA, it was necessary for the school to enlist a new independent panel to support the complaints process. Some of the independent panel members were required to communicate with you by email and process your data in order to deal with the complaint and achieve an outcome. In such circumstances, when independent panel members do not have school email addresses, they nominate an email account to use for communication purposes in order to progress the complaint process. We can reassure you that those individuals all received appropriate data protection training to ensure compliance with the relevant legislation and that your data has not been shared beyond the members of the independent panel.

We appreciate the concerns you have raised and we will continue to support the school to process data in the best way possible, with transparency, when they are required to do so in order to support parents and children. The pandemic has required schools to consider new ways of working in order to meet their obligations to pupils and parents and to support, without interruption, processes including the complaints process. The school will continue to review the way in which data is shared with those who need to access it in order to ensure that data sharing is always limited to the individuals who are required to process it. Our review with the



school has included looking at the process of sharing personal data and advising the school to use non-email sharing options whenever possible, which has now been put in place, and the use of school-based email accounts at every opportunity.

The school has confirmed that your personal data, which was processed by the independent panel solely for the purpose of the complaints process has been deleted by all panel members. We hope that this provides you with reassurance.

If you are not satisfied with the way that the school has sought to resolve your concerns you may use the school's formal complaints procedure as set out in the schools policies and procedures on the school website.

You also have a right to contact the Information commissioner who may be contacted using the following email address; <https://ico.org.uk/global/contact-us/>

Yours sincerely,
Mrs C Martin
Data protection consultant
Data Protection Education Ltd